

Fire -- Ohio Players

Fire, 1974. 116 BPM, est.

Marshall "Rock" Jones' bass on this one is the whole engine of the groove -- round, punchy, fingerstyle P-bass tone sitting right in the pocket with the horns and clav, not a modern scooped slap tone.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg810 IR (User IR 3)

Ampeg SVT through an 8x10 is the default '70s funk/soul bass rig, and it's a direct hit for this record's era.

Classic Bass is the GP-5's own SVT sim, Apg810 (Ampeg SVT-810E) is the real-world cab match -- same brand family, the most direct pairing in the IR set.

- Gain: 42 -- enough tube push for warmth, not enough to grind. This tone stays clean at the amp; any grit comes from the DST stage on the chorus hits, not from cranking the amp itself.
- Bass: 60 -- full, round low end.
- Middle: 62, MidFreq: 800Hz -- pushed hard. This is what gets the bass through a horn section -- without upper-mid presence a P-bass disappears under brass.
- Treble: 55 -- enough top end for pick/finger attack, not brittle.
- VOL: 70.
- CAB VOL: 62.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 20. Light touch -- clean amp tone doesn't need much gating, just enough to kill hum between phrases.

PRE -- COMP (Ross Compressor), always on.

Sustain: 55, VOL: 65.

Funk bass lives and dies on an even pocket. This squashes the pick/finger dynamics down so every note in the groove sits at the same level -- the classic "glued to the kick" funk bass feel.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 30, Blend: 55, VOL: 68, Bass: 55, Treble: 52.

Off for the verse groove -- clean SVT tone only.

On for the "Fire" chorus hits and the horn stabs -- a light push that thickens the bass without turning it into a distorted tone, so the low end punches harder under the horns and Sweet Cherie's vocal without losing note definition.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 42, Bass 60, Middle 62, MidFreq 800Hz, Treble 55, VOL 70.

CAB -- User IR 3 (Apg810), always on. VOL 62.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1, always on.

33Hz: +5, 150Hz: -3, 600Hz: +4, 2kHz: +5, 8kHz: +3, VOL: 52.

Low end reinforced at 33Hz for weight, a cut at 150Hz to keep it from getting boomy, and a push through 600Hz-2kHz for the finger-funk "pop" that cuts through the clav and horns. A little 8kHz air for string attack.

MOD -- off. Straight funk bass tone -- no chorus or modulation. Adding any would just smear the note definition this groove depends on.

DLY -- off. No delay -- tight, dry pocket part.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 18, Decay: 25, Trail: off.

Off for the verse groove -- dry and right on top of the beat, same as the amp/DI tone on the record.

On alongside the DST boost for the chorus -- a small amount of room air to help the bass sit a touch bigger under the horn stabs without smearing the groove.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: DST (Bass OD) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- main verse groove. Clean SVT tone, compressed, dry, tight in the pocket. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- chorus / "Fire" hook sound. Light OD push plus a touch of room, same amp tone underneath, bigger and punchier for the hits.

Engage CTL going into the chorus and horn-stab sections, back off for the verse groove.